

058. Chapter 4 Verses 38-41

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 4.38

न हि ज्ञानेन सदृशं पवित्रमिह विद्यते ।
तत्स्वयं योगसंसिद्धः कालेनात्मनि विन्दति ॥ 38 ॥

*na hi jñānena sadṛśhaṁ pavitramiha vidyate
tatsvayaṁ yogasansiddhaḥ kālenātmani vindati*

na—not; hi—certainly; jñānena—with divine knowledge; sadṛśhaṁ—like; pavitram—pure; iha—in this world; vidyate—exists; tat—that; svayam—oneself; yoga—practice of yog; sansiddhaḥ—he who has attained perfection; kālena—in course of time; ātmani—within the heart; vindati—finds

Indeed there is nothing so pure as Knowledge in this world. He who is perfected in Nishkama Karma finds that wisdom by himself in Atma in due season.

VERSE 4.39

श्रद्धावान् लभते ज्ञानं तत्परः संयतेन्द्रियः ।
ज्ञानं लब्ध्वा परां शान्तिमचिरेणाधिगच्छति ॥ 39 ॥

*śhraddhāvānlabhate jñānaṁ tat-paraḥ sanyatendriyaḥ
jñānaṁ labdhvā parāṁ śhāntim achireṇādhigachchhati*

śhraddhāvān—a faithful person; labhate—achieves; jñānaṁ—divine knowledge; tat-paraḥ—devoted (to that); sanyata—controlled; indriyaḥ—senses; jñānaṁ—transcendental knowledge; labdhvā—having achieved; parāṁ—supreme; śhāntim—peace; achireṇa—without delay; adhigachchhati—attains

The man of faith, having Knowledge as his supreme goal having controlled the senses, obtains knowledge of Atma, and having obtained that enjoys everlasting peace.

अज्ञश्चाश्रद्धधानश्च संशयात्मा विनश्यति ।
नायं लोकोऽस्ति न परो न सुखं संशयात्मनः ॥ 40 ॥

*ajñāśh chāśhraddadhānaśh cha sanśhayātmā vinaśhyati
nāyaṁ loko 'sti na paro na sukhaṁ sanśhayātmanaḥ*

ajñāḥ—the ignorant; **cha**—and; **aśhraddadhānaḥ**—without faith; **cha**—and; **sanśhaya**—skeptical; **ātmā**—a person; **vinaśhyati**—falls down; **na**—never; **ayam**—in this; **lokaḥ**—world; **asti**—is; **na**—not; **paraḥ**—in the next; **na**—not; **sukham**—happiness; **sanśhaya-ātmanaḥ**—for the skeptical soul

But the ignorant man, the faithless man, the doubting man goes to destruction. For the doubting self, there is no happiness either in this world or the next.

योगसंन्यस्तकर्माणं ज्ञानसंछिन्नसंशयम् ।
आत्मवन्तं न कर्माणि निबध्नन्ति धनञ्जय ॥ 41 ॥

*yoga-sannyasta-karmāṇaṁ jñāna-saṅchhinna-sanśhayam
ātmavantaṁ na karmāṇi nibadhnanti dhanañjaya*

yoga-sannyasta-karmāṇam—those who renounce ritualistic karm, dedicating their body, mind, and soul to God; **jñāna**—by knowledge; **saṅchhinna**—dispelled; **sanśhayam**—doubts; **ātma-vantam**—situated in knowledge of the self; **na**—not; **karmāṇi**—actions; **nibadhnanti**—bind; **dhanañjaya**—Arjun, the conqueror of wealth

O Arjuna! Actions do not bind the man who has surrendered the fruits of karma by yoga, whose doubts are cleared by Knowledge, and who is firmly established in the Self.